

SongBook3 Installation and Overview

SongBook3 is a plugin for browsing your ABC music library, searching both by artist and title, creating and organizing setlists, checking band readiness, synchronizing players, tracking songs played in a session, and automatically selecting lyrics, and sending them from a built-in window. It will not interfere or mess with existing SongbookBBLE or other Songbook plugins, and can be installed alongside them, if desired.

Contents

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1: Installation ▸ Pg2
2: Library Builder ▸ Pg3
3: Playing Music ▸ Pg5
4: Using Setlists ▸ Pg5
5: Using Lyrics ▸ Pg5
6: Settings ▸ Pg7
7: Controls ▸ Pg7

--- Credit Where it's Due ---

Chiran, for the original Songbook
The Brandy Badgers, for improvements on the original
Almiyan, for Songbook 2 BBLE
Elamond, for their patch to BBLE
Thurallor, for the original perl library builder

INSTALLATION

NEW INSTALL:

1: Extract the complete Sinduriel folder directly into:
(c:\\, proton pfx, etc)Documents/The Lord of the Rings Online/Plugins/

2: On Windows(Linux, etc see step 3), double-click
Plugins/Sinduriel/SongBook3_LibraryBuilder.hta
(or use Plugins/Sinduriel/Run_SongBook3_LibraryBuilder.cmd if MSHta is not associated with hta files).

3: On Linux, macOS, or Windows with Perl installed, you can instead run Plugins/Sinduriel/SongBook3_Scanner.pl . The scanner uses Perl core modules and no Unix-only shell commands. It accepts optional --music and --plugindata paths. Both builders scan Music for ABC files and Music/lyrics for mirrored TXT lyric files, save the generated indexes beside the builder in Sinduriel, and copy them to each account's PluginData/<account>/AllServers folder

4: Run the builder again whenever song or lyric text files change, then reload SongBook3 in LOTRO.

UPDATING FROM ANOTHER SONGBOOK3 VERSION:

1: Unload SongBook3 and remove the old Plugins/Sinduriel/SongBook3 folder before loading this release.

2: Install the new Sinduriel folder as described above.

3: Do not delete or rename the existing SongBook3 plugin-data files. The account and character data names are unchanged, so existing SongBook3 settings, setlists, library indexes, and manual lyric links continue to be used.

4: Updating from a version prior to v1.25.4 requires rebuilding the library. For versions after that, run the relocated scanner only when the Music library or mirrored lyric files need refresh.

PLUGIN IDENTITY AND DATA:

The plugin package loads from the Sinduriel.SongBook3 namespace and its assets are stored in Sinduriel/SongBook3. Its LOTRO shell command is /songbook3.
Do not use the older SongbookFiller.exe or songbook.hta utilities with this plugin; they write the old SongbookData filenames.
The following account/character data names are used:

- SongBook3Data.plugindata
- SongBook3Lyrics.plugindata
- SongBook3LyricLinks.plugindata
- SongBook3Setlists.plugindata
- SongBook3Settings.plugindata

No other plugin's data is loaded, migrated, or overwritten. Other Songbook plugins can remain installed in their own creator folders. Do not remove the SongBook3 data files if you want to retain your current SongBook3 configuration.

LIBRARY BUILDER

Remember, anytime you modify, add or remove music or lyric files, re-run one of the Library Builders!

Windows:

For Windows XP through Windows 11, double-click SongBook3_LibraryBuilder.hta.
If .hta files are not associated with MSHTA, run Run_SongBook3_LibraryBuilder.cmd.

The HTA file scans the LOTRO Music folder, generates SongBook3Data.plugindata and SongBook3Lyrics.plugindata files, and copys them to each account's PluginData/<account>/AllServers folder.

If you do not yet have an AllServers folder in your PluginData/<account>, you may need to create one manually if the program just writes a file called AllServers instead of creating the folder. The program reads the My Documents location from Windows and offers folder pickers if Music or PluginData is elsewhere.

If PluginData has no account folders, the builder checks UserPreferences.ini for LOTRO usernames. If no names can be found, enter the account name in the form.

To run the HTA file, simply double click it, and input the requested information.

Alternatively, the SongBook3_Scanner.pl Perl script is cross-platform. With Perl installed, it can be run from the Command Prompt using:

- perl SongBook3_Scanner.pl

Optional explicit paths are supported:

- perl SongBook3_Scanner.pl --music "C:\path\to\Music" --plugindata "C:\path\to\PluginData"

Do not try to use the legacy SongbookFiller.exe or songbook.hta with SongBook3. Those older builders generate the legacy SongbookData.plugindata format and do not build the separate SongBook3 lyrics index. The plugindata files also do not carry the same name, so Songbook3 won't read older songbook2.plugindata libraries. Use SongBook3_LibraryBuilder.hta or SongBook3_Scanner.pl instead.

If you run into an issue with the HTA, let me know and I will try to get it fixed.

Linux/MacOS:

Open your wine/proton/other-compatibility-layer prefix's user/Documents/Lord of the Rings Online/plugins/Sinduriel folder in a terminal or cd into it. Set SongBook3_Scanner.pl as executable, then type:

- perl ./SongBook3_Scanner.pl

Then enter the full directory to your music library without quotes when prompted. Make sure your lyrics folder is beside your music folder. Example Debian/Ubuntu location:

- /home/user/.steam/debian-installation/steamapps/compatdata/212500/pfx/drive_c/users/steamuser/Documents/The Lord of the Rings Online/music

Enter the full directory to your music library without quotes when prompted. The path to your music is likely the folder containing your Plugins folder, /music. See example above.

As with Windows, the script can be run with explicit paths:

- perl SongBook3_Scanner.pl --music "/path/to/Music" --plugindata "/path/to/PluginData"

Since the script can be run with explicit filepaths, you can use an update.sh(or equivalent) script to run the builder without needing to open the folder or terminal.
If the script succeeded, you should now have a library in Songbook. If it failed, check the messages it gave, and check your filepaths. Verify there is a folder named AllServers in each account's plugindata folder. If AllServers isn't there, create the empty folder, otherwise the script may name the first plugindata file AllServers and fail because it can't create the rest, since AllServers is then not a directory.

Backward Compatibility:

SongBook3 will not see older versions of .plugindata files. If you want to try to reuse your old songbook2 file, these are the names of all SongBook3's .plugindata files:

- SongBook3Data.plugindata
- SongBook3Lyrics.plugindata
- SongBook3LyricLinks.plugindata
- SongBook3Setlists.plugindata
- SongBook3Settings.plugindata

You can try renaming SongbookData.plugindata to SongBook3Data.plugindata if you want to try using your old library file. I don't recommend trying this, but it's an thing that could potentially be done. Doing so will, of course, break your old SongBook version unless you rebuild or rename it again. Artist search and display will not function at all.

HOW TO ACTUALLY USE IT

Solo:

To play a song, simply load the plugin, either through the Plugin Manager or with:

- /plugins load "Songbook3"

Navigate through your library in the main window, select a song(and part, if applicable), enter music mode (either by clicking the M button, clicking your equipped instrument in the Songbook Quickslot, or by typing '/music') and click play!

With a Band:

To play a song, navigate to the song in your library, select a part(for multi-file songs, just pick the right file), click the 'Play Sync' button twice, once all members have synced, the leader clicks 'Start Sync Play'.
Wrong instruments will trigger an error, missing instruments will not.
Errors open the Check Sync panel automatically. Click play to bypass the error, or fix the error if it's real.
You can keep the Sync Check window open and use the play button there if you want to bypass the error check completely. While the panel is open, you can refresh the status by clicking 'Refresh'.

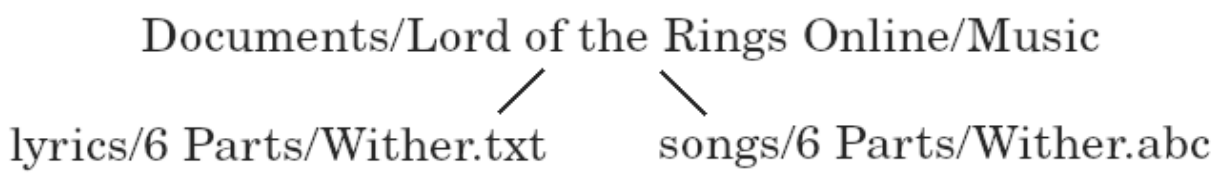
Creating and using setlists:

- To build a setlist, click 'Setlists', type a name for the setlist, click 'Create/Open', select a song in the main window, click 'Add Song' in the setlist window, repeat.
- To share a setlist to the fellowship, click 'Share Setlist' and send all the parts by clicking the 'Send Parts' button until it disappears, then click ignore if you don't want a second copy of the setlist. Those receiving it should accept.
- To remove a song, Highlight it and click 'Remove'.
- To rearrange, highlight a song and click 'move up' or 'move down'.
- Clicking a song in the setlist opens it in the main window.
- To see a list of songs you've played this session, click 'Session'.
- You can mark played songs unplayed(removes song from Session list), or add songs to the played list from the main window with 'Mark Played'.
- You can jump directly to a song shown in the Session list by clicking 'Select Song'.
- You can erase the session list with 'Reset Session'.

Using Lyrics:

If your library folders are set up with abc songs and txt lyrics files mirroring each other, you can open the Lyrics window and click 'Jump To Main Song' to automatically select the correct lyrics file without having to manually link the files.
If you don't have your library set up that way, you can browse your folders, find the correct lyric file, and then click 'Link To Main Song' to create a link, so next time you select that song, 'Jump To Main Song' will work properly.
You can also clear links, including automatically assigned links.
You can use the 'Previous'/'Next' buttons to navigate lyric lines, or simply click on a line to select it. The highlighted line is the line that will be sent if you click 'Send Line'.

Example folder structure for automatic lyric linking to fully shine:



It's some work to initially create the structure, but it's worth it to have automatic lyric file selection. ABC and Lyric files can be as deeply nested as you want, but if you're creating a library intended for both SongBook3 and BBLE, you'll have to avoid nesting deeply, as BBLE does not read more than a couple levels deep. The example structure would not function in BBLE.
I strongly recommend using Songs and Lyrics as the two top level folders, with one or more libraries beneath them.
This example is a minimally nested configuration. You can, of course, have a completely un-nested structure, but for lyric files to be found and browsable, they should always be somewhere in music/lyrics/, even if your abc's are directly in music/.
You can always manually link lyric files to abc files, even if they're already linked to another version of a song.
As with abc updates, anytime you modify, add or remove lyric files, run one of the Library Builders.

Searching:

With properly formatted abc files(Those that list an artist in the 'C:' field), you can search by artist. Check the box in settings, type an artist name (or part of one), and hit enter or click the main search button. The results will display in the usual song display box. Normal search works as well. With a library of properly formatted files, the main search functions as a title search, and artist as artist. If your files vary, you may need to search both fields individually to find all songs by an artist.

COMMANDS:

You can use console commands if you prefer them, or if you've lost the icon and can't find it(like on a bunch of tiny windows when running a full band).

- /plugins load "SongBook3" — Load the plugin.
- /songbook3 show — Show the main window.
- /songbook3 hide — Hide the main window.
- /songbook3 toggle — Toggle the main window.

The floating SongBook3 icon toggles the full workspace, including the timer.
Clicking the timer collapses the workspace while leaving the timer and floating icon visible; clicking the timer again or the icon restores the previous window visibility.
Previously open panels are always reopened when toggling the workspace.

SETTINGS AND CONTROLS

Most of the settings are self-explanatory. The Leader Mode checkbox turns on and off the 'Start Sync Play' button. If you're a band member that doesn't want the ability to start sync play, uncheck the box. Count Down shows or hides the timer in the main window. Play around with the description display settings and artist search options until you find a display that suits your preferences. If you are in a raid, you must set the manual chat selection to Raid Chat, otherwise sync and announce messages will not display as they should to other groups in the raid.
In the Lyrics tab, you can change the prefix(a symbol or series of symbols that is placed in front of each lyric line), set the comment prefix(default is '%', ignores/skips lines beginning with this symbol), choose whether to hide or show blank lines, and set a delay that disables the send button for that amount of time after clicking.
The Settings window is resizable, options in the right column move to the bottom of the left column when the window gets too small.



Controls

Main Window with and without Artist Search enabled:





1 Activates/deactivates music mode.
2 Immediately plays the selected song as a solo.
3 Initiates a fellowship ready-check.
4 Syncs the currently selected song, it then turns into Send Sync Info, click it again.
5 Sends the currently selected song to the fellowship.
6 Shows what part you have selected. Clicking it will show/hide the parts box.
7 Starts Sync'd play. 'Leader Mode' shows/hides this button in Settings.
8 Sends an emote style message with what you are currently playing.
9 Recovers the user channel specified in Settings.
10 Joins the user chat specified in Settings, if different from default.
11 Allow you to search your library and clear your search.
12 Shows your folders, click '..' to go up a folder.
13 Shows the songs in the selected folder.
14 Shows the parts available in the selected song.
15 Place instruments etc into these quickslots for quick access.
16 Opens settings.
17 Opens setlists.
18 Opens lyrics.
19 Opens the sync check window.

If your Sync messages are not appearing in the plugin, momentarily hover over button 4 to reattach the chat callback handler. Some other plugins will hijack control.
The left panel shows “Show Descriptions” checked, the right window shows “Show Descriptions”, “Artist Search”, “Show Artist” and “Show Descriptions First” checked.
When search results are displayed, “(n)” shows the number of parts in each file.

Sync Check:



1 Refreshes status.
2 Starts Sync’d Play bypassing error check.
3 Closes the window.

Share Setlist:



1 Sends parts of the playlist. Keep clicking.You can click ignore in the panel that appears, if you shared it. If it’s being shared to you, accept it.
2 Closes the panel.

Setlists/Session:



1 Switches to the Setlist Tab
2 Switches to the session tab.
3 Text box for name of the setlist
4 Creates or opens the setlist name typed in the text box.
5 Shows setlists. Click to select.
6 Shows songs in setlist. Click to select.
7 Adds the selected song in the main window to the selected setlist.
8 Removes the song from the setlist.
9 Moves the song selected in the setlist up or down in the list.
10 Selects the next or previous song. You can also just click a song to select it.
11 Opens the setlist sharing panel.



1 Marks the selected song played.
2 Removes the selected song from session.
3 Reset Session clears the list.
4 Select Song reopens the selected song.

Lyrics:



1 Opens the song selected in the main panel in lyrics, if there is a linked file.
2 Establishes a link from the song in the main panel to the currently selected lyric file.
3 Removes any such links, including automatic ones.
4 Can be used to navigate lines, or you can click the desired line.
5 Sends and advances to the next line.
6 Restarts the file from the beginning.

CUSTOMIZATION:

You can replace the Timer Window background with any 150x94 pixel image you like, just copy it to Sinduriel/SongBook3/ and rename it 'SongBook3Timer.tga'. rename the original to something like SongBook3Timer.tga.old .

LANGUAGE:

There is limited localization carried over from BBLE. Localized LOTRO command aliases, instrument names, chat-message patterns, and existing translated labels. Translation coverage is partial at best: newer Lyrics, Session, and auxiliary-window labels are primarily English. The shell command accepts English actions and the legacy German/French action words: anzeigen/verstecken/umschalten and afficher/cacher/basculer.
If you would like to contribute translations, please let me know!